

Help! My Co-worker is Autistic!?

DENNIE DECLERCQ // 8TH NOVEMBER // P3X LONDON

Summary

- ▶ About me
- ▶ A fun fact = “developer’s logic vs autistic logic”
- ▶ Theory
- ▶ (Results) The behaviour
- ▶ (Solution) The autism-friendly co-worker

About me



- ▶ Dennie Declercq
- ▶ Volunteer developer!
- ▶ DDSOFT (nonprofit)
- ▶ [#DreamingIsBelieving](#)
- ▶ [@DennieDeclercq](#)
- ▶ Positive thinker

Developers Logic vs Autistic Logic

Developers Logic

- A boolean is true or false
- It's good to declare variables, what type it's expect
- If you program a loop, the exit scenario should be clear
- It's very structured

Autistic Logic

- A fact is only true or false
- It's very nice that every circumstance is declared
- If there's a path to follow, auti's like it's clear and clean
- Most of them are very structured

Autism



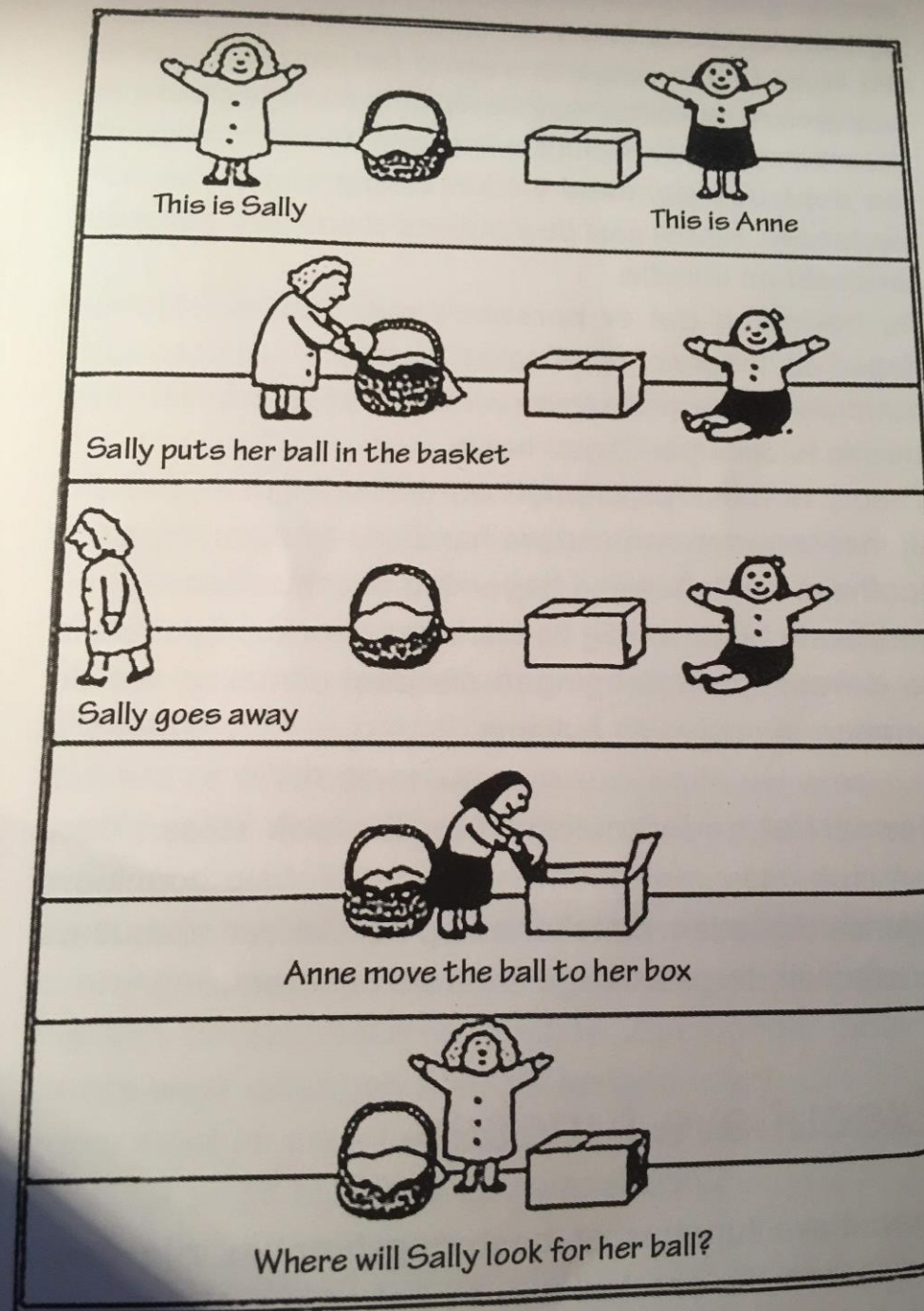
- ▶ A mismatch between:
 - ▶ Social Relationship
 - ▶ Communication
 - ▶ Imagination
- ▶ A Disability
- ▶ Being unique
- ▶ A very personal experience

A theoretical crash course



Theory of Mind

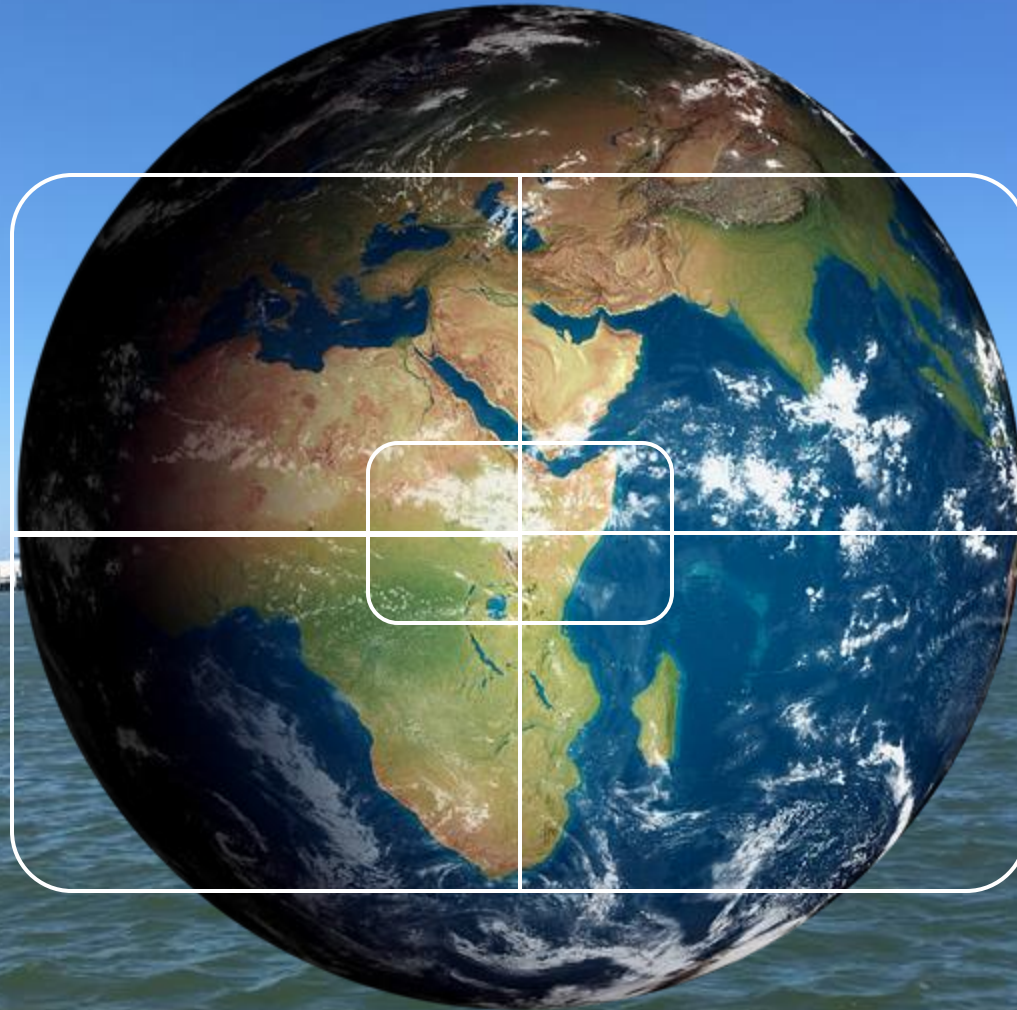
► Sally-Anne experiment



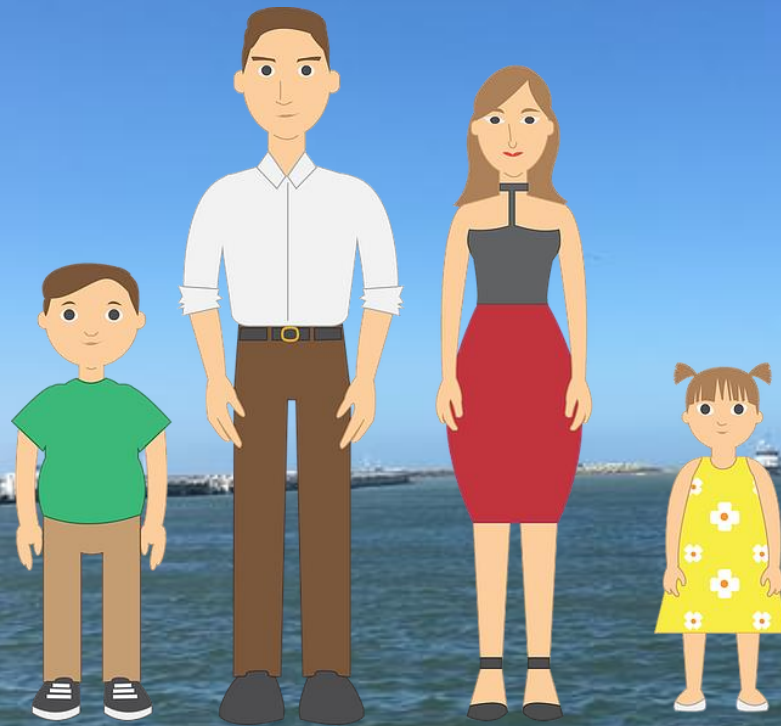
Executive Functioning



Central Coherence



Contextblindness



Sensoric overload



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Co-morbide diagnosis

Stress

ADHD

Anxiety

Depression

TALENTS!



This results in behaviour:



Too Honest

A woman with long, wavy red hair and bangs is shown from the chest up. She is wearing a light purple zip-up hoodie over a colorful patterned top. She has a concerned or questioning expression on her face, with her mouth slightly open. She is standing in front of a wooden bookshelf filled with books and colorful papers. The background is slightly out of focus, emphasizing the woman.

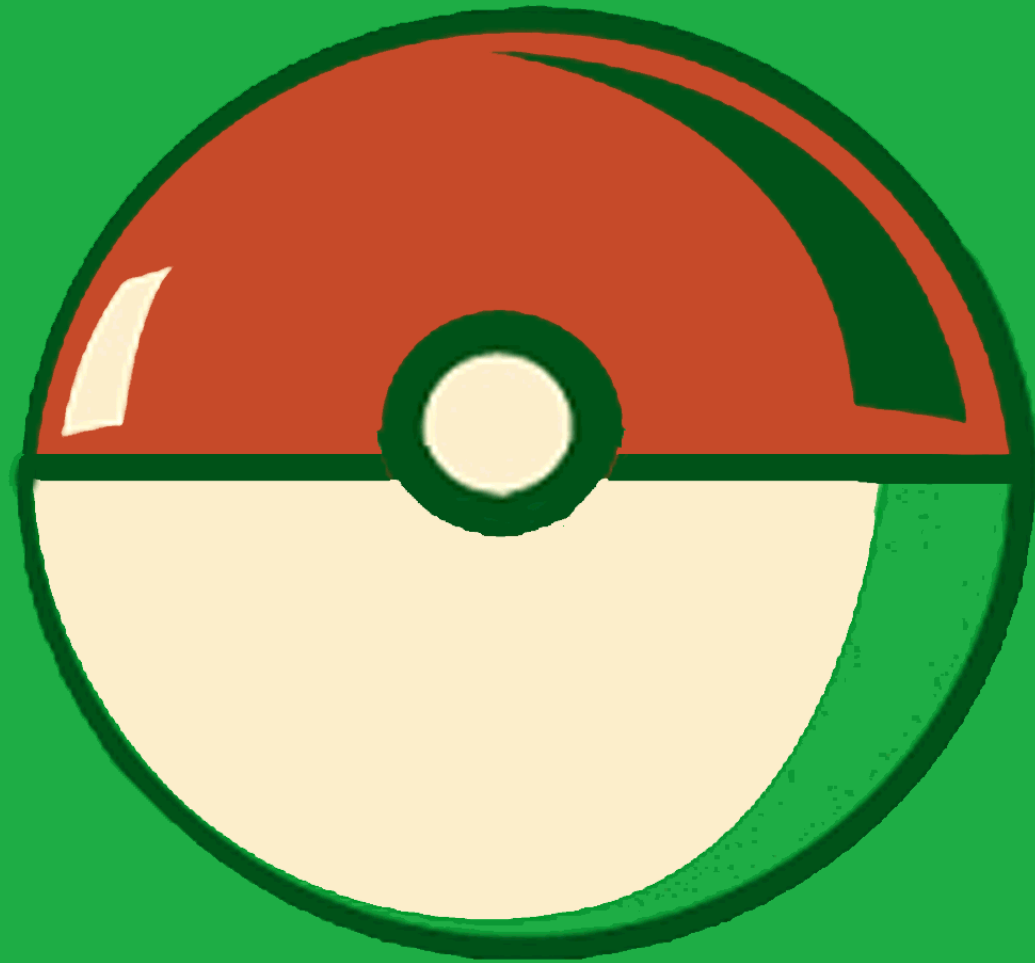
What is wrong with your face?

Cope with deadlines



DEADLINE IS COMING

Limited topics of interest



Talking: Too much or too little

STOP TALKING

Jokes?

It's a joke.



Solution: The autism-friendly co-worker
(== How to handle people with autism)



Structure

Difficulty

- ▶ Unorganized
- ▶ From A to D without B and C
- ▶ Weird way of structuring a 'programming environment'

Solution

- ▶ Help organizing
- ▶ Ask clarity
- ▶ Help setting up an environment
- ▶ Explain what is important and why

Planning

Difficulty

- ▶ Planning is too hard
- ▶ Impulsive planning
- ▶ Cancelled meetings

Solution

- ▶ Help with planning
- ▶ Set your own limits to meetings
- ▶ Send an easy reminder

Communication

Difficulty

- ▶ Talking too much
- ▶ Jokes
- ▶ Limited topics of interest

Solution

- ▶ Plan specific timeslots
- ▶ Explain your jokes
- ▶ Ask a few times about their interest
- ▶ Keep telling about your own interests!
- ▶ Set and show your own limits and indicate them

Work and deadlines

Difficulty

- ▶ Can't cope with deadlines
- ▶ Works slower
- ▶ Specific detail view

Solution

- ▶ Give project without deadlines
- ▶ Don't prioritize the deadline
- ▶ Make small goals
- ▶ Create time

Q&A | | Thank you!



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